

PENFLOW

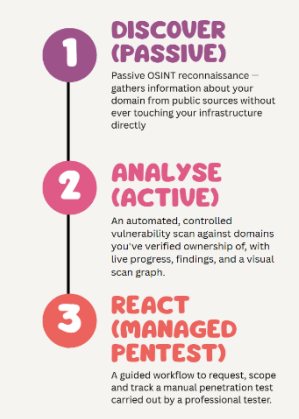
User Manual

PenFlow User Manual

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1. Introduction



PenFlow is a cybersecurity platform that brings passive exposure monitoring, automated external vulnerability scanning and managed penetration testing together into a single, continuous workflow. Instead of juggling separate scanning tools, email threads, spreadsheets and static PDF reports, PenFlow gives you one dashboard to discover your external attack surface, understand your risk, and — when you need deeper assurance — request a handsx`-on penetration test from a real tester.

PenFlow structures every assessment into three phases:

Who benefits from PenFlow?

- **Individual site owners and small teams** who want a quick, no-signup passive scan of their domain before committing to anything deeper.
- **Registered organizations** that want to continuously track their external attack surface, run recurring scans, and keep a history of how their risk changes over time.
- **Security-conscious teams** who eventually need a real penetration test and want the scoping, evidence and reporting to live in the same place as their automated scan data.

2. Key Features

- **Passive OSINT scanning** — no account or domain verification required to get a first look at your exposure.
- **DNS-based domain ownership verification** — a simple TXT record proves you control a domain before PenFlow will actively scan it.
- **Automated active vulnerability scanning** — port and service enumeration, technology fingerprinting, and CVE correlation against verified domains.
- **Scheduled scans** — set a domain to be re-scanned automatically on a recurring basis.
- **Scan history & delta reporting** — every scan is kept, so you can see what changed between assessments.
- **PDF reports** — download or email a branded report of any completed scan.
- **Managed penetration testing** — request, scope and track a full manual engagement with a real pentester, without leaving PenFlow.

- **Contextual Help** — every major page has a Help panel explaining what you're looking at and what to do next.

WOW Factor features — see 9. WOW Factor Features for the full picture:

- **Attack Graph** — a real-time, visual map of everything a scan discovers, updating as workers complete.
- **AI Security Analyst** — ask PenFlow's AI plain-language questions about your risk, answered only from evidence you're authorized to see.
- **Brand impersonation monitoring** — automatic detection of lookalike domains trying to impersonate a domain you've verified.

3. Requirements

- A modern, up-to-date web browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari). PenFlow is a web application — there is nothing to install.
- For **active scans** and **domain verification**: administrative access to your domain's DNS records (to add a TXT record).
- An internet connection. No special network configuration is required on your end — PenFlow's scan workers reach out to your domain, not the other way around.

4. Getting Started

4.1 Creating an account and logging in

1. Open PenFlow in your browser and select **Log In / Sign Up**.
2. Enter your details to create an account, or sign in if you already have one.
3. PenFlow may prompt for an additional verification step during login to keep your scan data secure.

On success, you're taken to your dashboard.

> **Note:** You don't need an account to run a first, passive OSINT scan — see 6.1 Passive OSINT Scan. An account is required to save scan history, verify domains, run active scans, schedule scans, or request a penetration test.



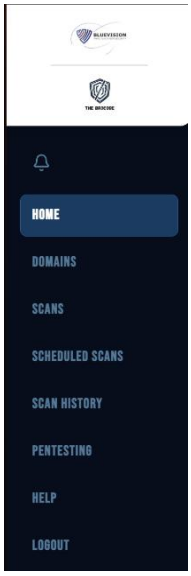
4.2 Your Dashboard

After logging in, you land on your **Dashboard** — a single-page summary of your security posture, with:

- **Quick actions** to start a scan, verify a domain, or schedule a recurring scan.
- **Top risky domains** — the domains in your workspace with the highest current risk scores.
- **Security Overview** — a snapshot of your overall exposure across every verified domain.
- **Running scans** and **critical findings** shortcuts, so anything urgent is one click away.



The main navigation also gives you access to:

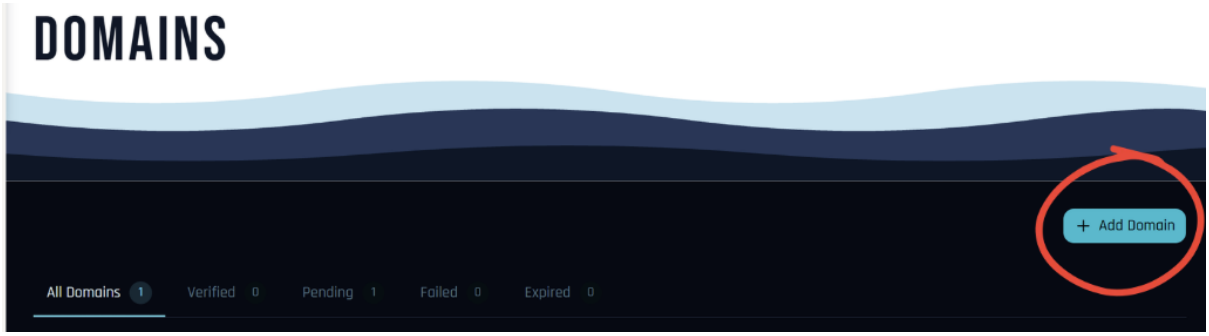


- **Scans** — start a new scan and view results.
- **Domains** — add, verify, search and manage the domains in your workspace.
- **Scheduled Scans** — manage recurring active scans.
- **Scan History** — every scan you've ever run.
- **Pentesting** — request and track manual penetration test engagements.
- **Ask PenFlow** — PenFlow's AI assistant, available from anywhere in the platform (see 9.2 AI Security Analyst (RAG)).
- **Help** — page-specific guidance (see 11. Getting Help).

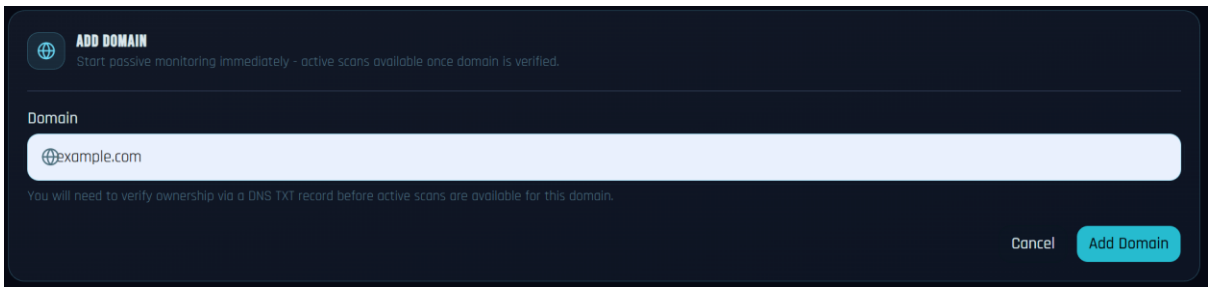
5. Managing Domains

Before you can run an active vulnerability scan against a domain, PenFlow needs proof that you actually own it. This protects everyone — it stops anyone from pointing PenFlow's active scanner at infrastructure they don't control.

5.1 Adding a domain



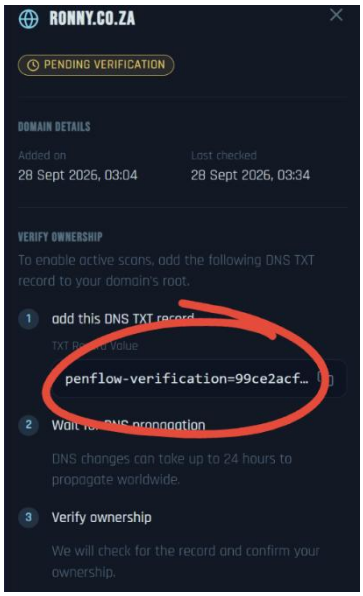
1. Go to the **Domains** tab and select **+ Add Domain**.
2. Enter the domain name (for example, `example.com`) and confirm.



3. The domain is added to your workspace with a **Pending** status, and PenFlow immediately walks you into the verification step below.

> If you try to add a domain that's already in your workspace, PenFlow will tell you it already exists rather than creating a duplicate.

5.2 Verifying domain ownership



1. PenFlow generates a unique verification token for the domain.
2. Add a **TXT record** at the root of your domain's DNS zone containing that token,

using your domain registrar or DNS provider's control panel.

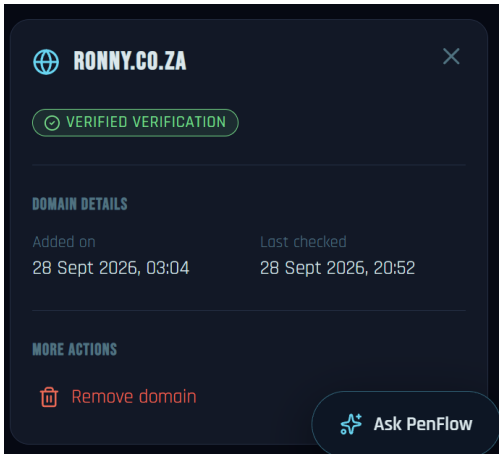
1. Once the record is published, return to PenFlow and select **Verify**.
2. PenFlow queries DNS for the matching TXT record. If it's found, the domain is marked

Verified and is now authorized for Phase 2 active scanning.

> **Tip:** DNS changes aren't always instant. If verification fails right after you add the record, wait a few minutes for propagation and try again before assuming something is wrong.



5.3 Viewing, searching and removing domains



- The **Domains** list shows every domain in your workspace along with its status, date added, and last-checked date.
- Use the search bar or status filter to quickly narrow a large list down to the domain you're looking for.
- Selecting **Remove** on a domain permanently deletes it and its associated scan history from your workspace — this cannot be undone.

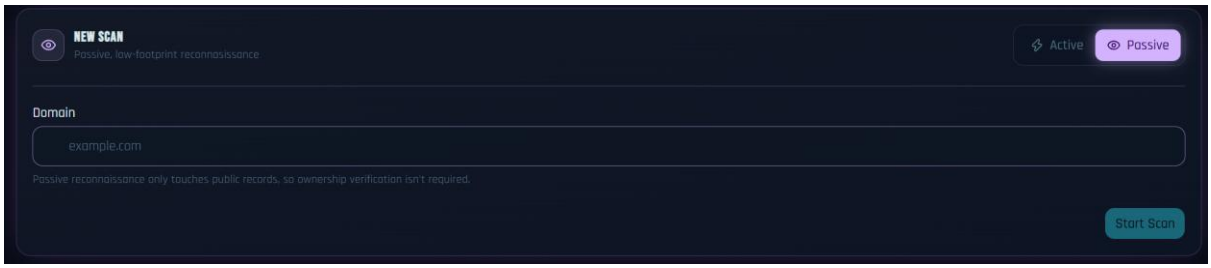
6. Running Scans

6.1 Passive OSINT Scan (Phase 1)

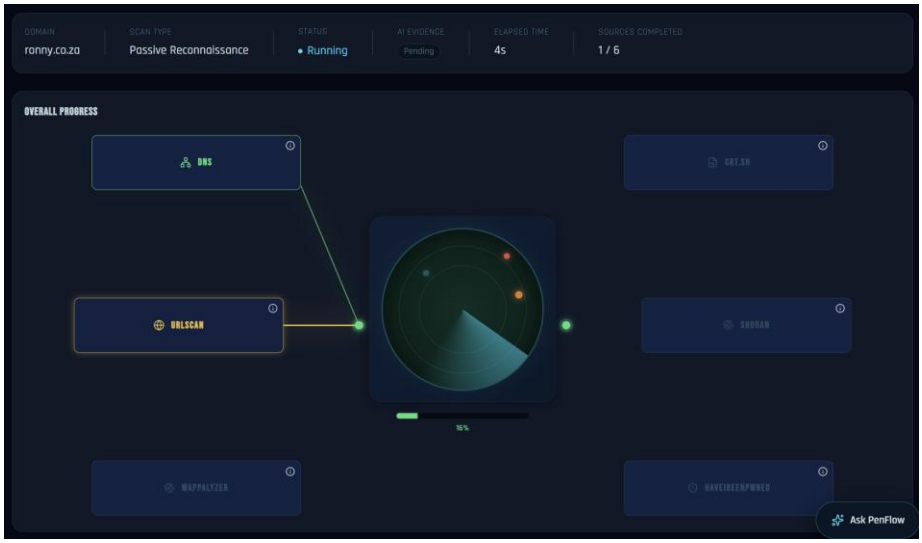
Passive scans gather information about a domain from public, third-party sources — PenFlow never directly contacts the target during this phase, so no ownership verification is required.

> **Tip:** You don't even need to log in first. PenFlow's homepage has a "Scan your domain" box you can use straight away — enter a domain and PenFlow runs a free passive scan on the spot, landing you on a standalone report page when it's done. Create an account any time afterward to save the result to your scan history.

1. Go to **Scans** and select **New Scan**.
2. Enter the target domain (and optionally an email address to be notified when it's done).



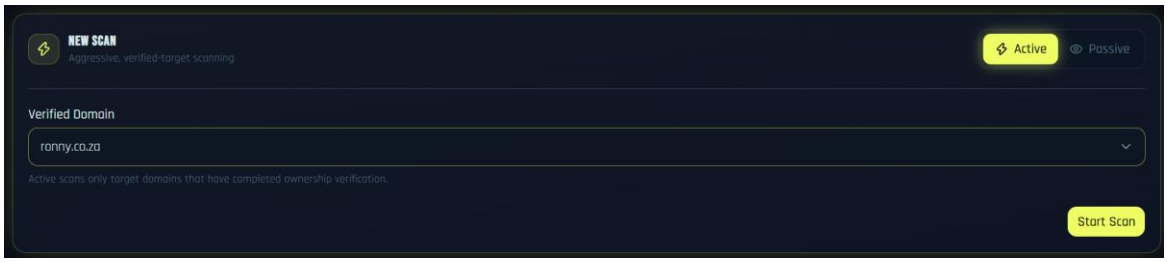
1. Select **Start Scan**.
2. PenFlow queries multiple OSINT sources concurrently in the background and redirects you to a live progress view.



If a particular data source is temporarily rate-limited or unavailable, PenFlow completes the report with whatever data it was able to gather rather than failing the whole scan.

6.2 Active Vulnerability Scan (Phase 2)

Active scans perform controlled, direct probing of your infrastructure — port and service discovery, technology fingerprinting, and matching against known CVEs — and can only be run against a domain you've verified (see 5.2).

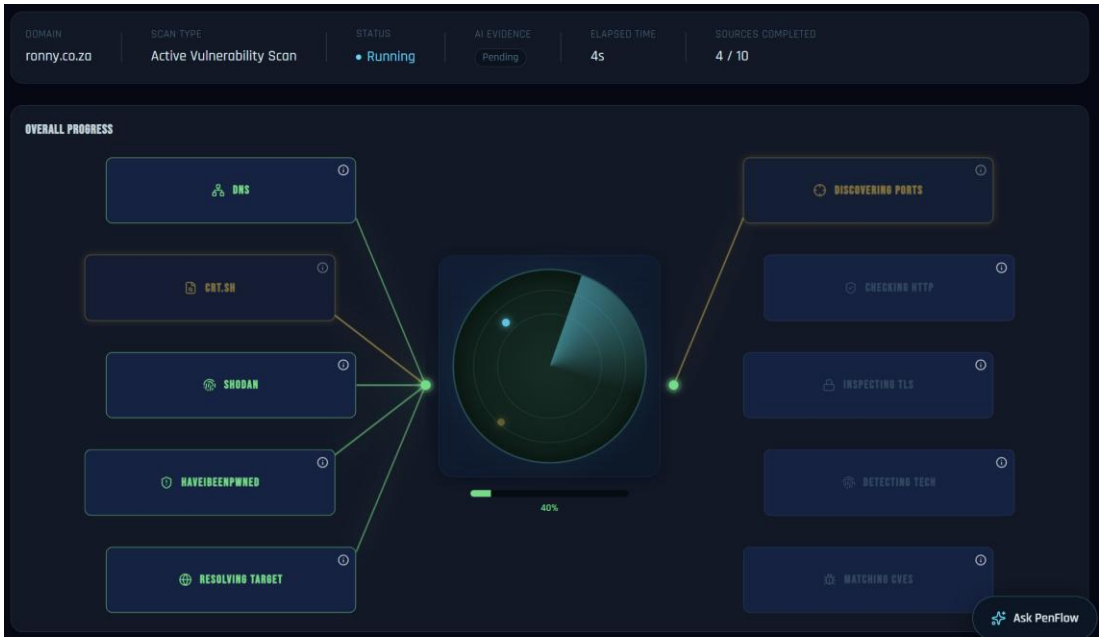


1. Go to **Scans**, select **New Scan**, and choose one of your **verified** domains.
2. Select **Start Scan** to begin the active scan.
3. You're taken to a live progress view showing each stage of the scan (resolving the target, discovering ports, inspecting services, detecting technologies, matching CVEs) as it completes.

6.3 Monitoring scan progress

While a scan is running, the progress page shows:

- A status indicator for each worker/stage of the scan, so you can see exactly what PenFlow is doing at any moment.
- A **View Scan Graph** link to watch discovered assets, services and findings appear visually in real time — see 9.1 Attack Graph.

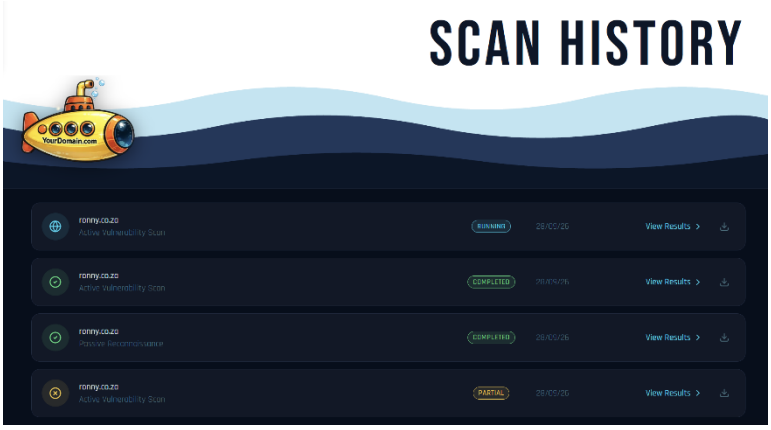


7. Scan Results & Reports

7.1 Scan History

The **Scan History** page lists every scan you've ever run, most recent first, with its status (Queued, Running, Completed, Partial, or Failed). From here you can jump straight into any past scan's results.

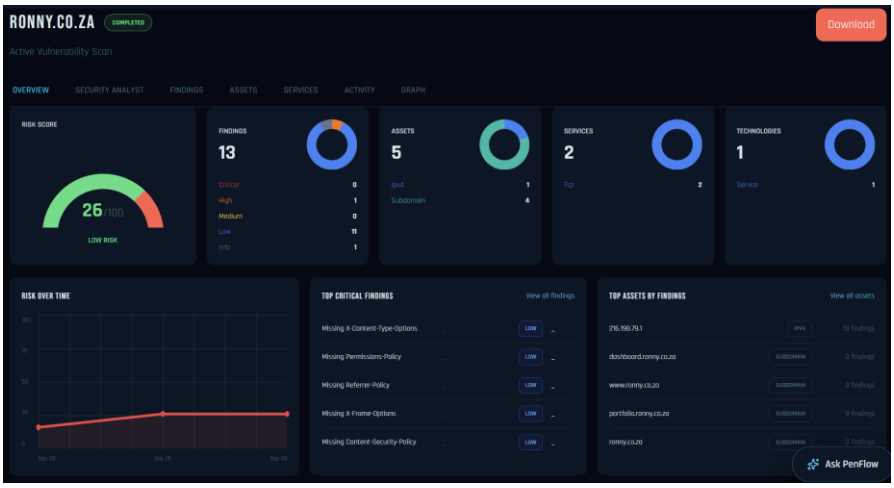
If you haven't run any scans yet, this page shows a call-to-action to start your first one.



7.2 Reading your results

Opening a completed (or in-progress) scan takes you to its results page, organized into tabs:

Overview	A risk snapshot — overall risk score, headline findings, and asset impact at a glance.
Findings	Every vulnerability discovered, with severity, CVSS score and remediation guidance.
Assets	Hosts, subdomains and other infrastructure discovered for the domain.
Services	Ports and services discovered on each asset.
Activity	A log of what each scan worker did.
Graph	The visual attack graph for this scan — see 9.1 Attack Graph.



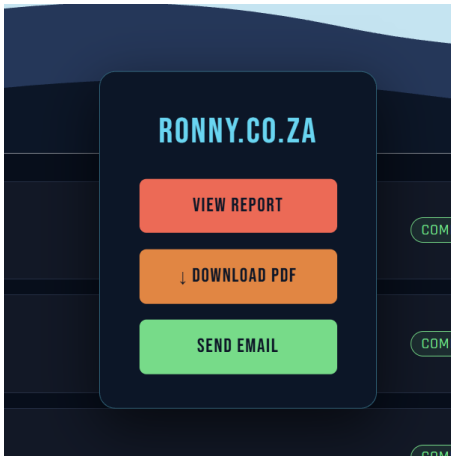
If this isn't the first scan you've run against a domain, PenFlow can also show you a **delta** against the previous scan, so you can quickly see what's newly introduced and what's since been resolved (see 9.1 Attack Graph).

7.3 Downloading and emailing PDF reports

From a completed scan's results page:

- Select **Download PDF** to save a branded report of the scan to your device.
- Enter an email address and select **Send** to have the same report emailed directly —

useful for sharing findings with a colleague or attaching to an internal ticket without downloading it yourself first.

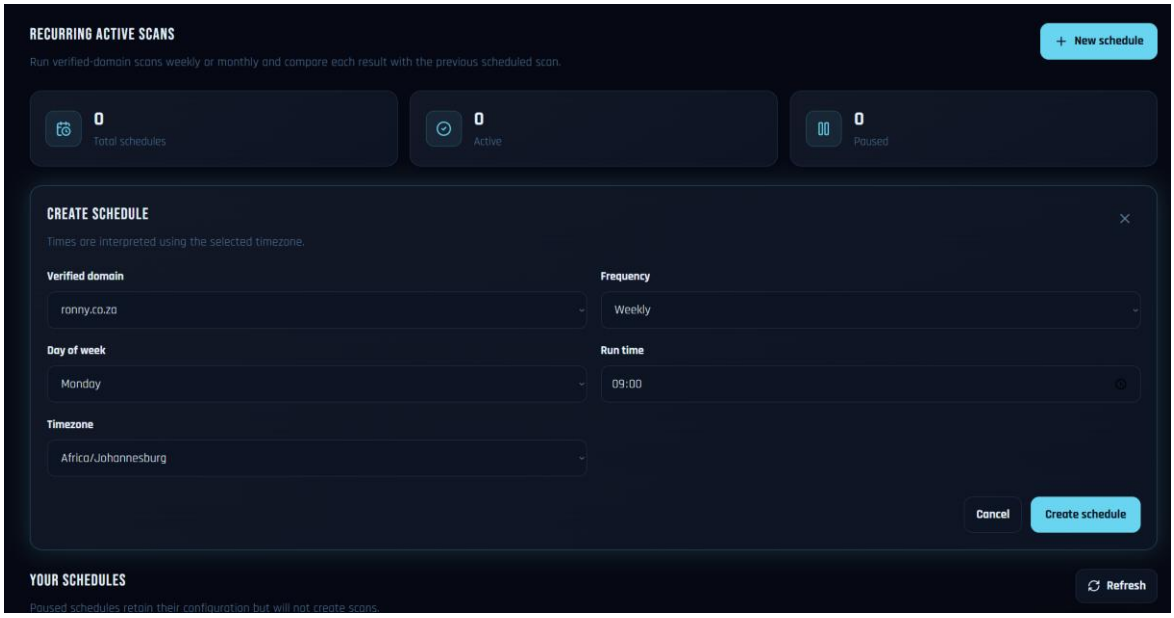


> If a report hasn't finished generating yet, PenFlow will queue it and ask you to wait a moment rather than giving you a broken file.

8. Scheduling Recurring Scans

Rather than remembering to re-scan a domain manually, you can schedule an active scan to run automatically on a recurring basis.

1. Go to **Scheduled Scans** and create a new schedule.
2. Choose a **verified** domain and the scan type.
3. Choose how often it should run (weekly or monthly), and the day/time.
4. Save the schedule.



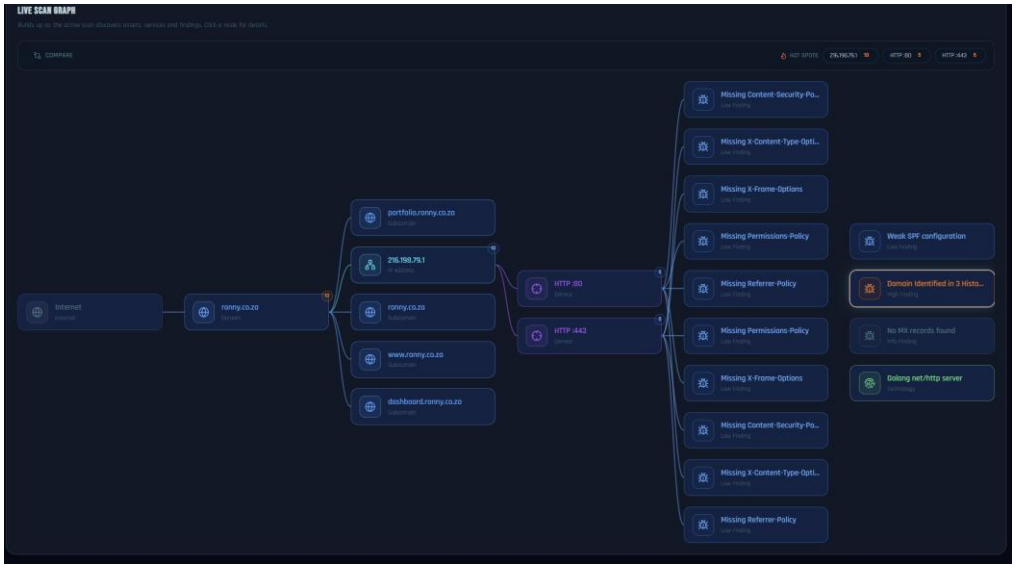
From the Scheduled Scans list you can see each schedule's next and last run time, and can **pause**, **resume**, or **delete** it at any time. You can only have one active schedule per domain and scan type, so PenFlow doesn't queue duplicate work against the same target.

9. WOW Factor Features

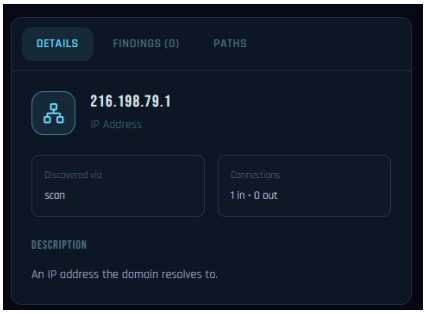
PenFlow goes beyond a standard scan-and-report tool with three flagship capabilities: a live, explorable map of your attack surface, an AI analyst you can question directly, and automated monitoring for attackers impersonating your brand.

9.1 Attack Graph

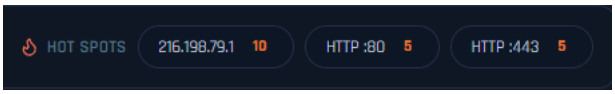
The Attack Graph (also shown as the **Live Scan Graph** while a scan is running) is a visual, node-by-node map of everything an active scan discovers — assets, services, technologies and findings — built up in real time as the scan runs.



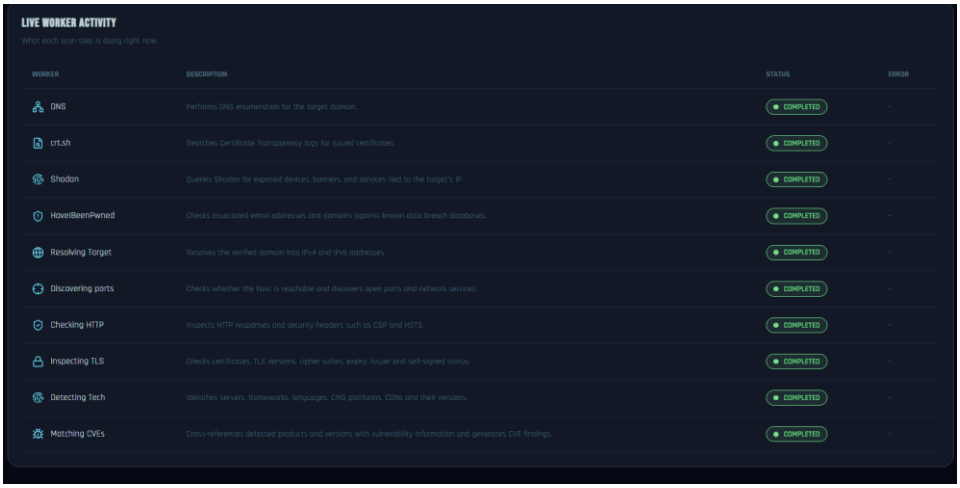
- **Opening it:** while a scan is running, select **View Scan Graph** from the progress page, from any completed scan's results page, open the **Graph** tab.
- **Reading it:** nodes are laid out by how far they are from your domain — the domain itself, then the assets and services discovered from it, then the technologies and findings attached to those. A node **pulses** while PenFlow is actively working on it, and newly-discovered nodes briefly highlight when they first appear, so you can watch the scan build out live instead of staring at a static page.
- **Node details:** selecting any node opens a panel with three tabs — **Details** (what it is), **Findings** (vulnerabilities tied to it), and **Paths** (the chain of assets and services that led to a given finding, so you can see *how* something was reachable, not just *that* it exists).



- **Hot spots:** a compact strip above the graph highlights the areas of the scan with the highest concentration of findings, so you can jump straight to what matters most.



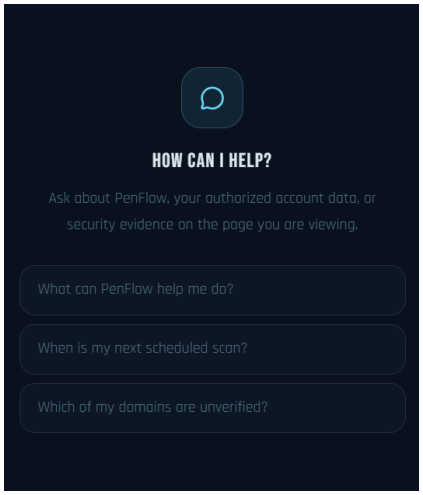
- **Worker activity:** on the full-page graph view, a table lists each scanning worker, what it does, and its current status.



- **Comparing to a previous scan:** if a domain has an earlier scan to compare against, a **Compare** toggle appears above the graph, showing new nodes, removed nodes, changed nodes, new connections, and how your critical/high risk findings have shifted since that previous scan. Nodes new since the compared scan carry a **NEW** badge directly on the graph.



9.2 AI Security Analyst (RAG)



PenFlow includes a retrieval-augmented AI assistant that answers questions strictly from your own scan evidence and findings — never from general knowledge — and always shows you the sources behind its answer.

- **Ask PenFlow:** a global assistant available from anywhere in the platform (look for the **Ask PenFlow** button). It opens a side panel where you can ask about your risk across your whole portfolio of domains and scans — not just one scan at a time — and choose an **answer mode** to match your audience:

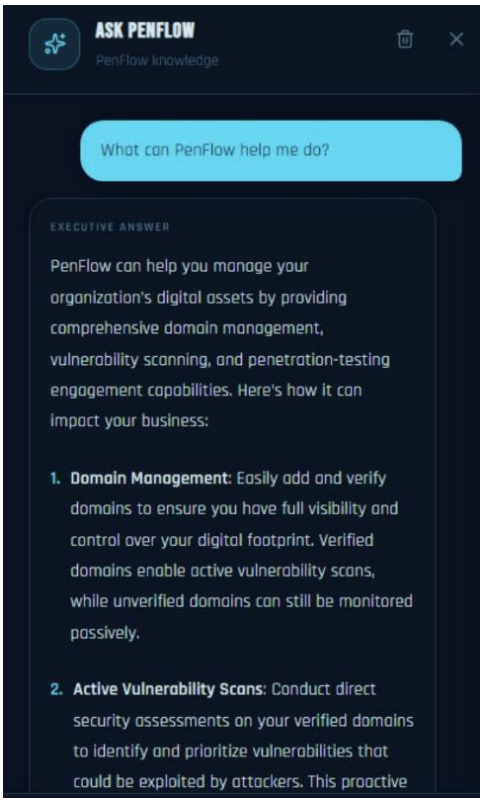
Executive	Business risk and decisions
IT Manager	Ownership and operational priorities
Security	Evidence and technical risk
Developer	Remediation and verification steps



Ask PenFlow can also answer general "how do I...?" questions about using the platform itself, compare two scans for you in plain language, and keeps a running conversation you can clear at any time.

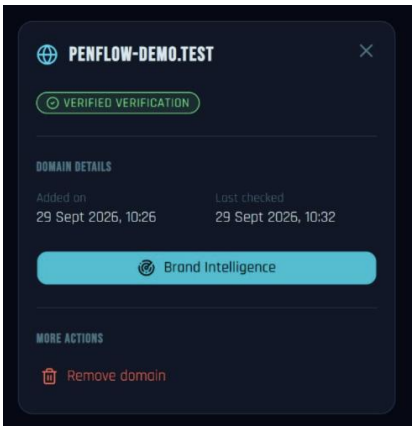
- **Security Analyst:** a scan-scoped version of the same assistant, found on a scan

results page. Select **Prepare analyst** to index that scan's findings, then ask a question (or pick one of the suggested prompts). Every answer lists the specific findings used as **evidence considered**, each linking straight back to that finding.

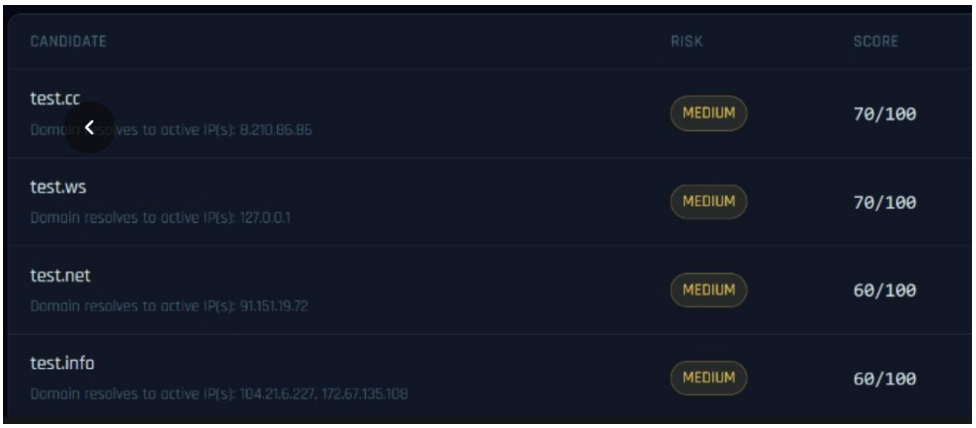


> **Note:** Answers are generated only from findings you're authorized to access, and PenFlow always shows its sources — treat the AI's answer as a starting point and verify remediation decisions against the cited evidence.

9.3 Brand Impersonation Monitoring



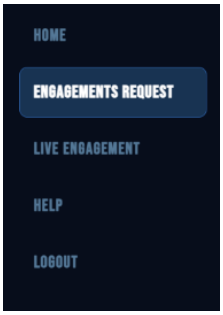
Once a domain is verified, PenFlow can continuously watch for lookalike domains attempting to impersonate your brand — a common precursor to phishing campaigns. Each candidate domain PenFlow finds is scored with a **risk level** (low, medium, high or critical) and tracked through a review workflow: **new** → **under review** → **confirmed impersonation** or **false positive** → **resolved**, along with the supporting evidence for why it was flagged.



10. Penetration Testing

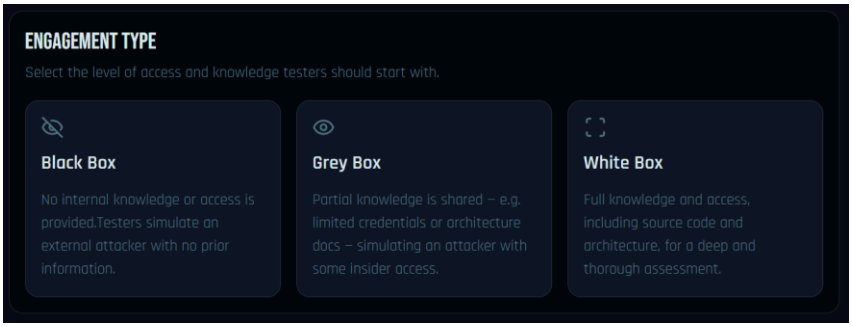
When automated scanning isn't enough and you need a real person testing your infrastructure, PenFlow's managed pentest workflow brings three roles together: the **User** (you, the client) who requests and tracks the work, the **Pentester** who carries it out, and **Service Delivery** staff who coordinate the engagement end-to-end. Each role has its own dedicated pages — this section covers each in turn.

10.1 Penetration Testing: User



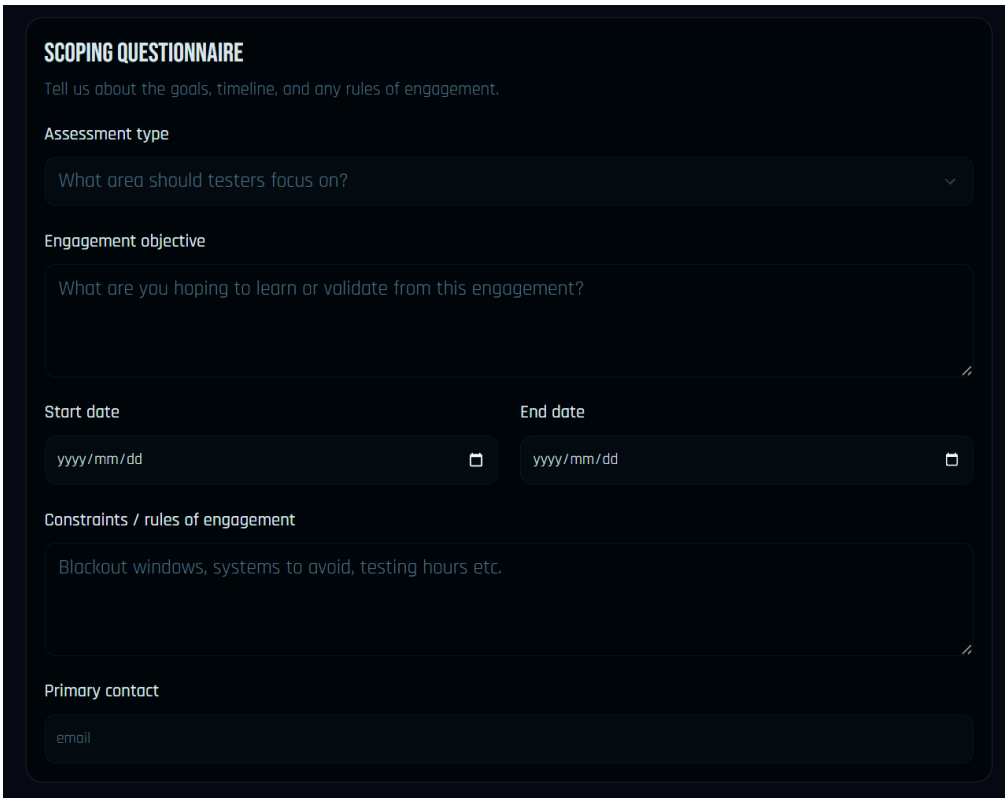
Requesting an engagement

1. Go to **Pentesting** and select **Request Engagement**.
2. Choose the engagement type:
    - **Black Box** — the tester starts with no internal knowledge of your systems.
    - **Grey Box** — the tester is given limited, partial access or information.
    - **White Box** — the tester is given full access and documentation up front.



3. Complete the scoping questionnaire: assessment type, objective, desired start and end dates (at least three days apart), any constraints the tester should be aware of, and a primary point of contact.

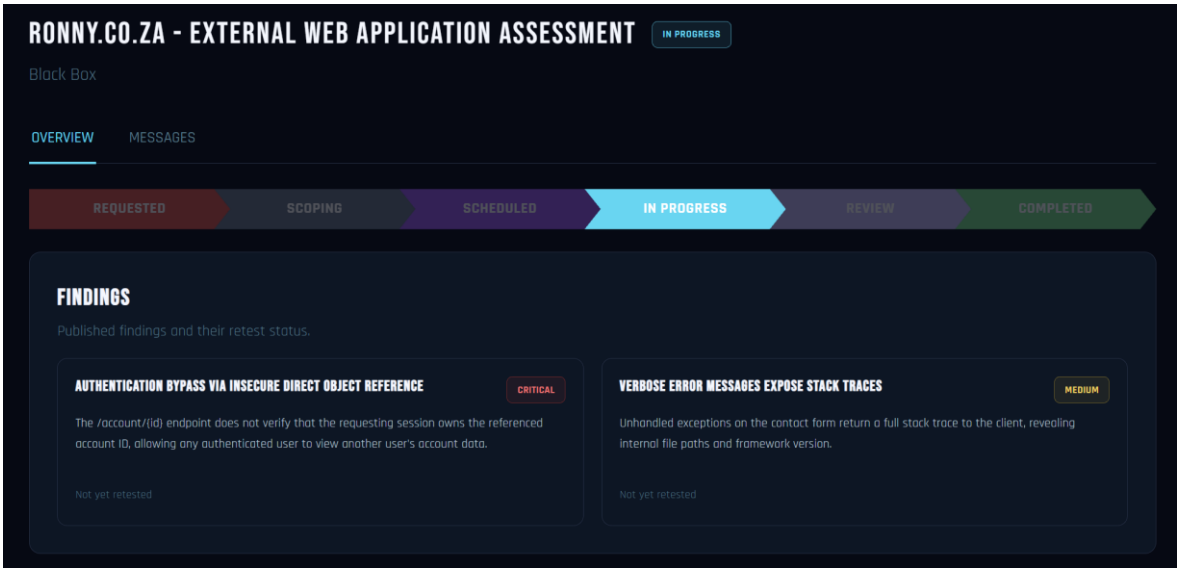
1. Declare the assets in scope — domains, IPs, hostnames or URLs the tester is authorized to test.

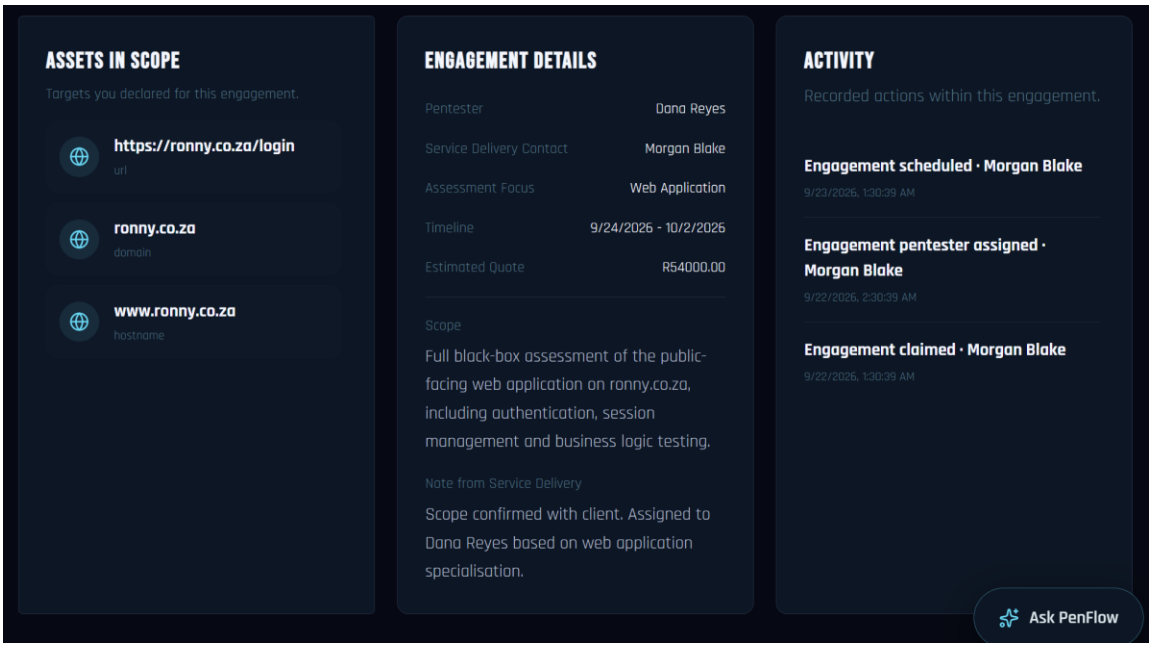


1. Submit the request. PenFlow's delivery team reviews it and returns an estimated quote.

Tracking a live engagement

Once an engagement is accepted and underway, the **Live Engagement** page shows the pentester assigned to it, its current status, the number of in-scope assets, and the due date and estimated quote. As the tester works, findings and evidence are added to the engagement. Open the **Messages** tab at any point to communicate directly with your assigned pentester about scope, access or questions on a finding. Once complete, you can open the engagement to review the full findings and the final report.



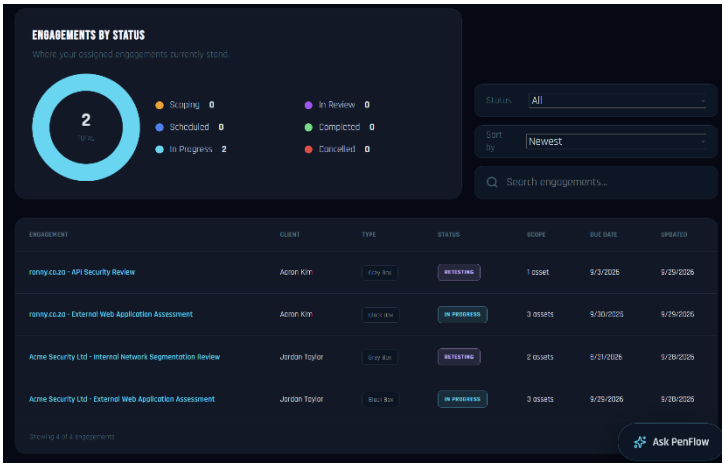


10.2 Penetration Testing: Pentester

Assigned testers manage their workload from a dedicated **pentester console**, separate from the client-facing pages above.

My Engagements — every engagement currently assigned to you, newest first, with a chart breaking your workload down by status:

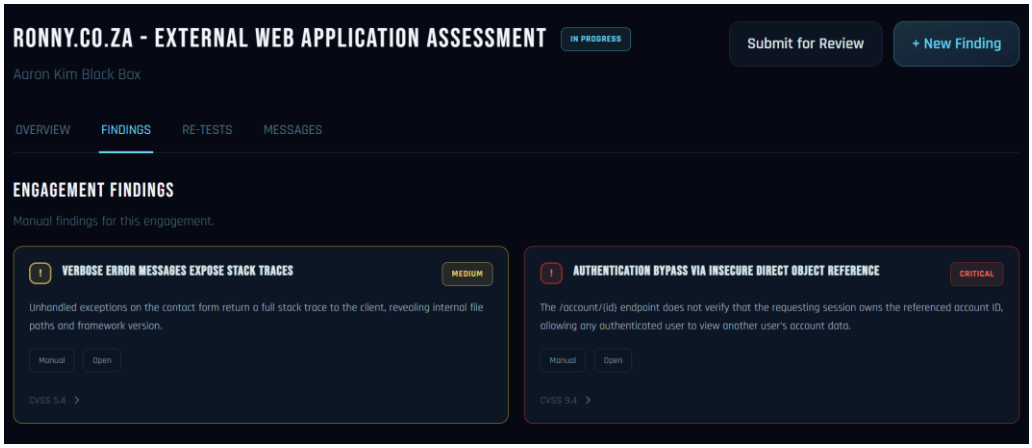
- **Scoping** — requirements and assets are still being defined.
- **Scheduled** — dates are set, testing hasn't started.
- **In Progress** — testing is underway.
- **In Review** — testing is done, findings are being finalised.
- **Completed** / **Cancelled** — the engagement has ended.



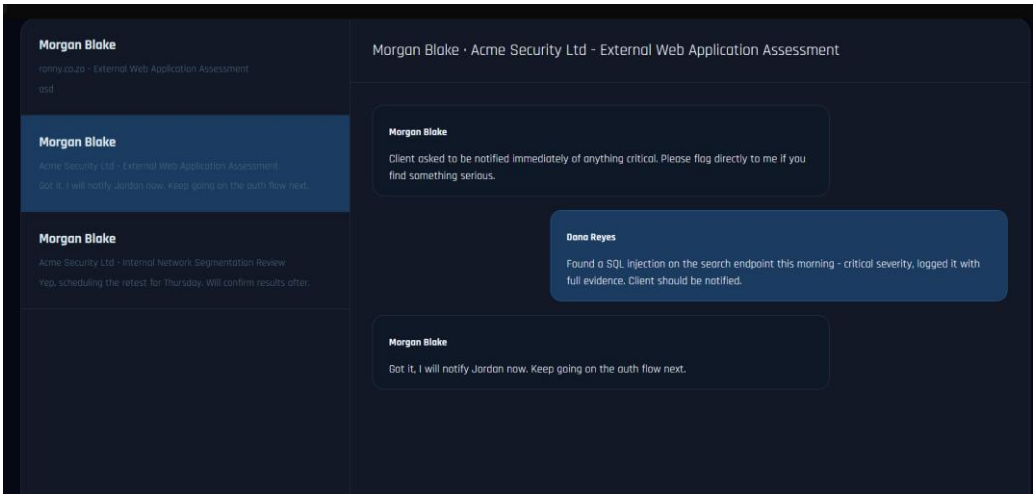
Use the status dropdown to narrow the table, sort by newest, due date or client name, and search by engagement title or client. Select an engagement's title to open its detail page.

Engagement detail — each engagement opens into tabs for **Overview**, **Findings** (log and manage the vulnerabilities you discover, with severity and status), **Re-tests** (verify a fix once a client requests one), and **Messages** (talk directly to the client).

All Findings — a cross-engagement view of every finding you've logged, filterable by severity, status (open, in progress, resolved, accepted risk, or false positive), and whether it was added manually or came from an automated scan.



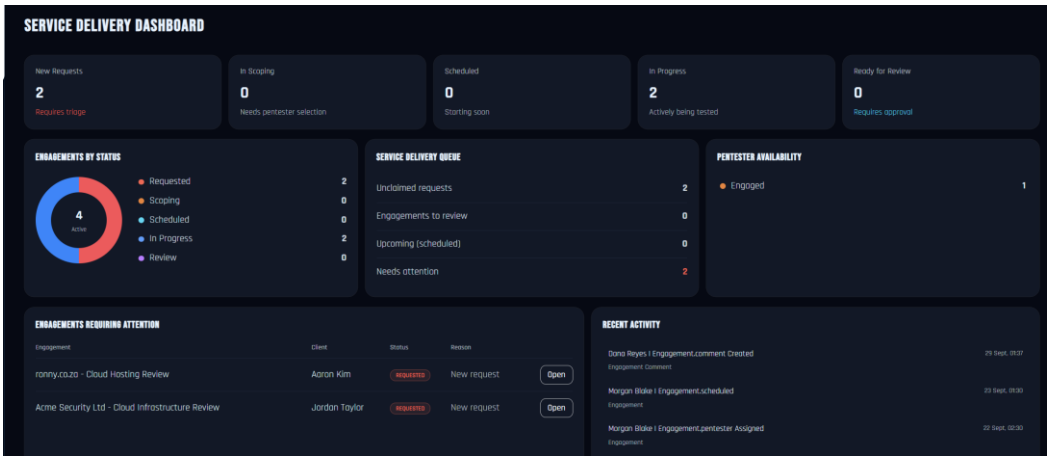
Messages — all your client conversations in one inbox, organised by engagement.



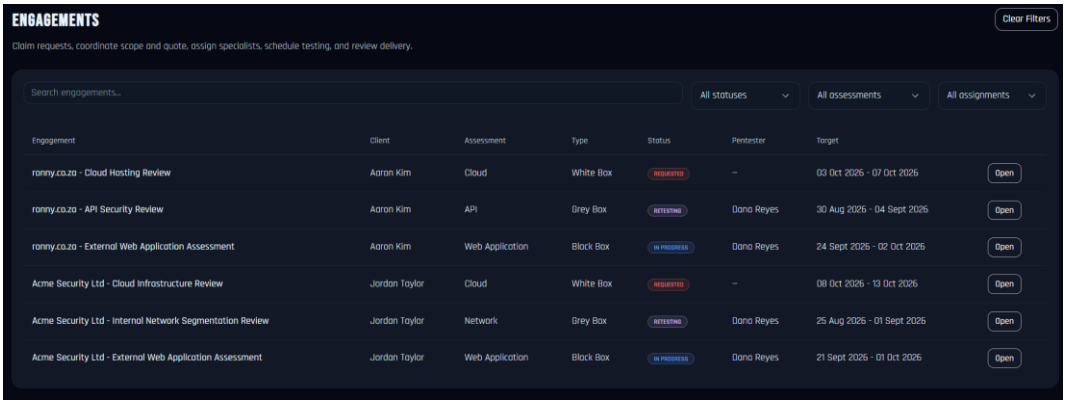
10.3 Penetration Testing: Service Delivery

Service Delivery staff coordinate engagements between clients and pentesters from a dedicated console.

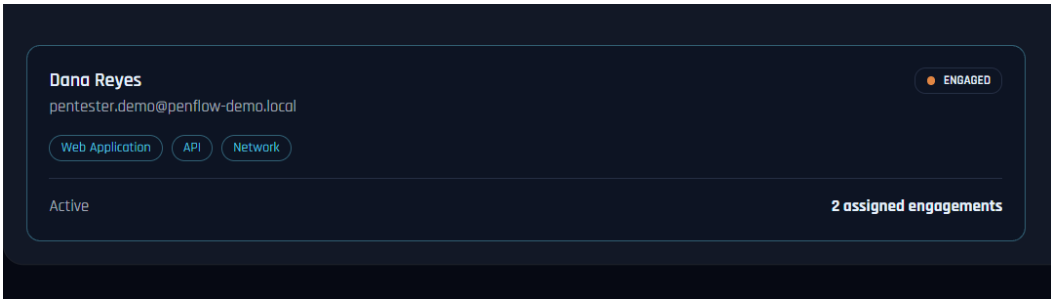
Dashboard — an at-a-glance view of every engagement in the pipeline: a status breakdown (requested, scoping, scheduled, in progress, review, completed, or cancelled), the pentester roster, recent activity, and a "needs attention" list for engagements that need a decision.



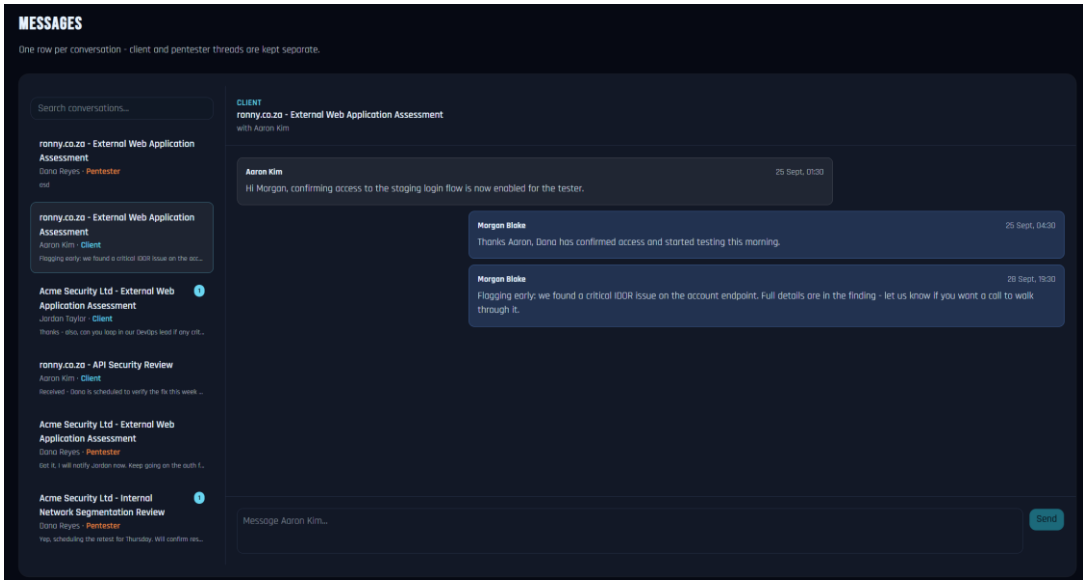
Engagements — the full organisation-wide engagement list. Search it, or filter by status, assessment type, or whether a pentester has been assigned yet — this is where an unassigned request gets matched to a tester. Opening a completed engagement that a client has requested a retest on shows a **Retesting** status and the retest queue; the engagement stays read-only until every open retest is resolved.



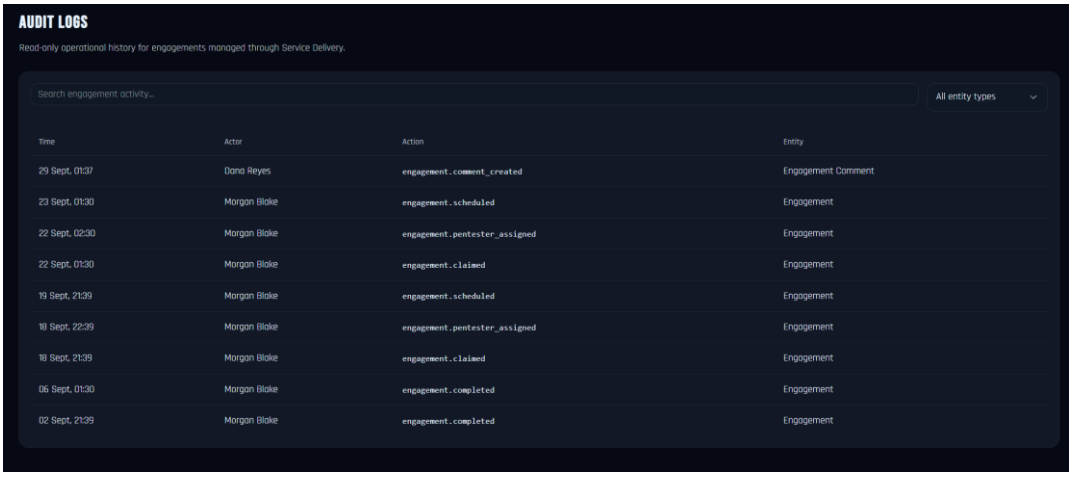
Pentesters — manage the tester roster: add or remove pentesters, set their specialisations (web application, mobile application, API, network, cloud, or other) and availability (available, engaged, or unavailable), and filter the list the same way.



Messages — two message channels per engagement, Client ↔ Service Delivery and Service Delivery ↔ Pentester, so coordination happens without always looping in both sides directly.

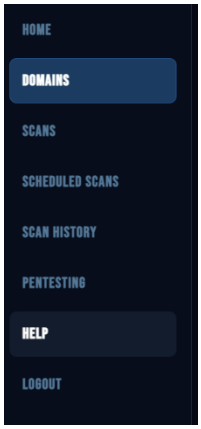


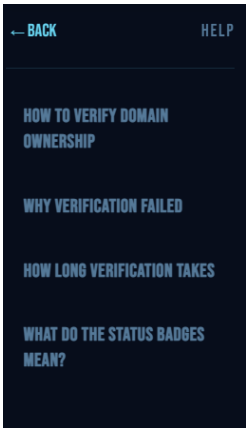
Audit Logs — a read-only, searchable history of every action taken on an engagement, filterable by activity type — useful for accountability and dispute resolution.

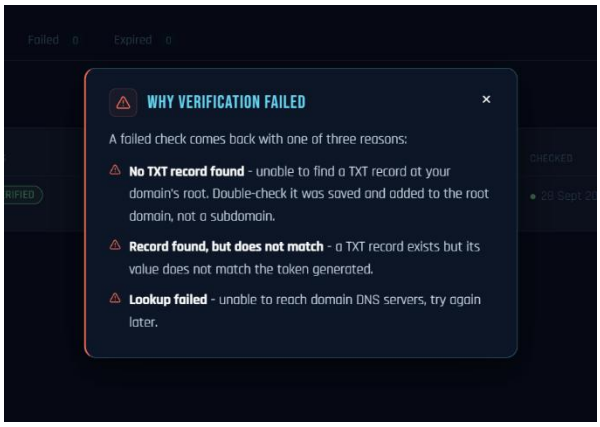


11. Getting Help

Every major page in PenFlow — Scheduled Scans, Scan History, active/pentesting scan pages, Live Engagement, and Engagement Request — has a **Help** tab in the navigation bar. Opening it shows page-specific guidance explaining what that page is for, what the key actions do, and what to check if something looks wrong, without having to leave the page or search external documentation.







12. Managing Your Account

PenFlow accounts may have different roles depending on how you use the platform:

- **Client / regular user** — the default role: add domains, run scans, view results, request engagements (see 10.1 Penetration Testing: User).
- **Pentester** — assigned engagements appear in a dedicated console for managing findings and messaging clients (see 10.2 Penetration Testing: Pentester).
- **Service Delivery** — reviews and manages engagement requests and assigns testers (see 10.3 Penetration Testing: Service Delivery).
- **Administrator** — full platform oversight.

Notifications relevant to your account (scan completion, engagement updates, and so on) appear via the notification icon in the navigation bar.

13. Recommendations

- **Verify your domains early.** Verification can take a few minutes to propagate — do it before you're in a hurry to run an active scan.
- **Re-scan regularly.** A single scan is a snapshot. Set up a scheduled scan for anything you care about keeping an eye on.
- **Use the Attack Graph's Paths tab** to understand *why* something is exposed, not just that it is — it's the fastest way to explain a finding to someone else on your team.
- **Compare scans after every re-scan** so you know at a glance whether your risk went up or down, rather than re-reading the full findings list every time.
- **Ask PenFlow before you dig manually** — try the AI Security Analyst in Executive mode for a quick summary before reading a full findings list, and in Developer mode when you're ready to fix something.
- **Escalate to a managed pentest** for anything automated scanning flags as high-risk but you're not fully sure how to remediate, or before a major release or audit.

14. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: Domain verification keeps failing even though I added the TXT record. A: DNS changes can take anywhere from a few minutes up to 24 hours to propagate depending on your provider. Double-check the record is on the domain's *root* (not a subdomain), that its value matches exactly what PenFlow gave you, and try again after a short wait.

Q: Can I run an active scan without verifying the domain? A: No — only passive (Phase 1) scans can run without verification. Active scanning requires proof of ownership so PenFlow never scans infrastructure you don't control.

Q: My scan shows "Partial" status — is that a failure? A: Not necessarily. A partial status usually means one or more data sources were temporarily rate-limited or unreachable during the scan. PenFlow still reports everything it was able to gather.

Q: I cancelled a scan but it still shows as completed. A: Occasionally a scan finishes in the same moment you request a cancellation — PenFlow lets the completed result stand rather than discarding real data.

Q: Why can't I add the same domain twice? A: PenFlow keeps one record per domain to avoid duplicate scan history and conflicting verification state. Remove the existing entry first if you need to start fresh.

Q: What's the difference between the Findings tab and the Attack Graph's Paths tab? A: The Findings tab lists *what* was found. The graph's Paths tab shows *how* it was reached — the chain of assets and services leading to it — which is often more useful when prioritizing remediation.

Q: Can the AI Security Analyst make things up? A: It's designed not to — every answer is generated only from your own indexed findings and always lists the specific findings ("evidence considered") it used, so you can verify the answer yourself rather than take it on faith.

15. Contact & Support

For questions not covered by this manual or the in-app Help panels, reach out to the PenFlow team at **thebrocodetuks@gmail.com**.